television. The *Calypso* was badly damaged in 1996, but Cousteau died suddenly in 1997 before he could afford to replace it.

See also: A plastic wasteland

PIERRE DANSEREAU

1911–2011

Dansereau was a French Canadian plant ecologist who pioneered the study of forest dynamics and is considered one of the "fathers of ecology." Born in Montreal, he gained his Ph.D. in plant taxonomy at the University of Geneva in 1939. He later helped set up the Montreal Botanical Garden and wrote numerous papers on botany, biogeography, and the interaction of humans and the environment. In 1988 he was appointed Professor Emeritus at the University of Montreal, a post he held until he retired, aged 93, in 2004.

See also: Biogeography

MARY LEAKEY

1913–1996

London-born Mary Leakey, one of the world's foremost paleoanthropologists, experienced her first archeological excavation at the age of 17, when she was hired as an illustrator at a "dig" in Devon. In 1937 she married paleoanthropologist Louis Leakey, and the couple moved to Africa to work in the Olduvai Gorge—a site rich in fossils—in what is now Tanzania. In 1948, Mary found the fossil skull of an 18-million-year-old ancestor of apes and humans, *Proconsul africanus*. More breakthroughs in understanding human ancestry followed, including the discovery in 1960 of *Homo habilis*, a 1.4–2.3-million-year-old hominid who used stone tools.

See also: Evolution by natural selection